

Frequently asked questions

what is this initiative all about?

Fibrehood is building its fixed telecommunications fibre optic network to deliver broadband (ISP services) and is considering installing an open access fibre network into your residential area / building subject to feasibility criteria being met.

what is FTTH?

Fibre-to-the-home (FTTH) is the installation and use of optical fibre from a central point directly to individual buildings such as residences and apartment buildings to provide unprecedented high-speed internet access.

what does Open Access mean?

Open access simply means that multiple service providers will be able to deliver services over the network infrastructure that is built in your building allowing you to choose from a variety of ISP's (Internet Service Providers) including Fibrehood.

I already have a fibre in my area / building, why should I install a Fibrehood network?

The fibre installed by any other fibre network operator is exclusive (closed) to other service providers. This means that residents cannot choose to access services from another ISP unless the ISP installs their own infrastructure in your building which presents several problems of clutter, trenching, security, noise, disturbance and cost etc.

The Fibrehood network that we install is open to all service providers which enables you to **CHOOSE & SWITCH** service providers when you desire and you will never need any other infrastructure installation in future.

what factors enable Fibrehood installation within your building

We take various factors into consideration. The most important include, but are not limited to;

- The number of units in your MDU / Area.
- The demand for high speed broadband required by the residents.
- The availability of other fibre network operators in the area.
- Existing infrastructure features i.e. existing ducts, poles etc.

what additional value do we bring to add value to your premises.

- Elimination of future disruption caused by independent infrastructure installations (digging, noise, security etc.).
- Reduced installations footprint (i.e. duplication of conduits, satellite dishes, etc).
- Faster and cheaper service activation.
- Increase of property value.

how will the residents gain financial benefit?

- The main benefit to subscribing residents is the saving on their Wi-Fi subscription as a result of having access to the lowest priced service provider. Connectivity has become an essential utility just like water & electricity. Not having choice exposes the residents to expensive service providers. The ability to **CHOOSE** their preferred service provider and **SWITCH** whenever desired ensures that there is competition amongst service providers for them to compete to supply services at the **BEST PRICE & QUALITY**.

how long does the installation take?

The duration of the construction is dependent on the size of the building/ area and therefore can only be confirmed once the survey has been completed. Generally, a typical installation is completed within a period of three (3) months.

Note: We will do everything we can to minimize disruptions. Refer to our installation principles attached.

where in my premises will it be installed?

Access - Fibre is brought into your building from either a wallbox on your wall or from a network access manhole installed at an identified spot outside the complex usually in the street boundary or entrance gate.

We will then Install a lead-in pipe (ducts) from the access manhole to the building. This will require trenching for laying of common ducts if not already provisioned.

Distribution - We will install a fibre demarcation box at the wall access point into building. You may need to provide a route inside the building from the building entry point into your utilities room where our equipment will be installed.

We will then Install fibre cable from the fibre demarcation box to each floor typically up the existing building riser pipe to a distribution box installed on each floor.

We will then install the fibre drop cables which are to go from the distribution box on the floor to each home unit through trunking installed along the corridors.

Termination - We will install customer premises equipment (ONT/ONU) at a pre-identified and agreed wall location inside each unit. Fibre is generally terminated behind your TV in the living room.

what equipment will be installed in the home unit?

For your data (Wi-Fi) connection we install a small device called an Access Termination Box (ATB). For your DStv connectivity we will install a small device referred to as a Fibre Termination Unit (FTU). See Fig. 3 below.

does the installed equipment belong to me?

The infrastructure and equipment is property of Fibrehood and should not be removed without the explicit permission. The benefit of this is that Fibrehood will at its' own cost replace any faulty equipment. However, in the event that you purchase your own Wi-Fi Router, it will remain your property.

what is the cost of the Fibrehood installation?

Our network infrastructure throughout the building and to every home unit is installed at **NO COST** to the tenant or Residents Association as it is funded entirely by Fibrehood.

what benefit do I get beside having fibre network?

Besides enabling high speed internet connectivity, our network infrastructure can also provision for delivery of;

- ✓ DStv over Fibre
- ✓ CCTV security
- ✓ Access control
- ✓ Wi-Fi Hotspots
- ✓ Future & weather proof building – fibre supports smart metering services & home devices automation i.e. IOT and is not affected by bad weather.
- ✓

Once the network is installed, are we required to sign-up for service?

NO! You are not obliged to sign up for any service. Only subscribing residents will be required to pay service costs.

what do I pay upon subscribing for service?

On choosing to subscribe for service, a subscribing tenant will typically pay:

- Fee for activation / Connection
- Service subscription
- Wi-Fi Router (If not provided by your ISP)
- Device (i.e. TV, Laptop, Decoder, Cellphone etc.)

how much will we pay for service activation?

Fibrehood's service activation only cost (if you select Fibrehood as your ISP) is typically around US\$85 for an MDU resident subscriber. Please consult with your ISP of preference who may or may not have activation fees for their services.

I already have a Router; can I use it?

The fibre installed requires a Router specific to fibre broadband as the service will not work with an ADSL router. Unless you purchase your own Router, generally you will not be able to use a Router provided by another ISP.

I now have a Fibrehood network in my home, how do I activate it?

Contact an Internet Service Provider (ISP) of your choice and let them know that you already have fibre in your home and place an order for the service or package that you would like activated over the fibre infrastructure. If your selected ISP already has a fibre network in your area they will activate your service over our infrastructure. The time taken to complete the set-up depends on a number of factors from ISP to ISP.

I have chosen one of my ISP, who do I contact for support services?

When you are with one of our ISP partners, all your communication and support needs will come directly from them. Fibrehood is legally contracted to the ISP and they will handle all communication between yourself and Fibrehood.

Fibrehood will only get directly involved in cases where there are issues with the network infrastructure.

What is the difference between Fibre, ADSL and LTE?

Fibre uses the transmission of light signals through glass fibre cables and is therefore capable of much higher speeds than the copper-based ADSL.... Ever heard of 'the speed of light'? that is what fibre is and because fibre makes use of transmission at the speed of light, the signal between points is much faster than DSL and LTE.

It is not susceptible to weather conditions and theft like the copper cables used by ADSL or the LTE technology which sends wireless signals between cell phone towers on specific wireless frequencies and LTE is capable of similar speeds to fibre but at a much higher cost for data

okay yes, we want it...what now?

If you represent a Residents Association or Home Owners Association, then you will need to sign our **Access & Installation Agreement of Expression of Interest Form** (specimen attached) to provide us with permission to start the feasibility process and ultimately install the network.

Alternatively, send an email to admin@fibrehood.co.zw and refer us to the correct person within your organization to arrange for the above.

You can also express your interest online at www.fibrehood.co.zw and we will contact you with further details.

